

Correction (See disclosures for details)

Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888)

3Q25 – revenue beats expectation with a positive revision to management guidance

Our take: a strong beat. STAN 3Q revenue and normalized pre-tax profits beat company compiled consensus by 3%/14% respectively. NII was +1% q/q, ahead of cons. by 2%. Non-NII was 4% ahead, led by Wealth (+27% y/y) and Banking (+23% y/y) although with Markets weaker as previously flagged (+1% y/y with flow income +12% y/y). Balance sheet momentum remained strong with underlying loans +1% q/q and deposits +2% q/q. Impairments were well managed at 24bps CoR, leading to a PBT that was 14% ahead of expectations and driving CET1 to 14.2%, 10bps ahead. Based on the strong 9M25 print, management has upgraded 2025 ROTE guidance to 13%, and expects ROTE to progress from there going forward, this against previous guidance of “reaching 13% in 2026” (cons. 2025 13.1%, 2026 12.7%). Overall, we expect a single-digit EPS upgrade to consensus EPS estimates across 2025-27. Given STAN is trading at a 0.9x P/B with a 12.7% ROE (current cons.) on 2026 estimates, at ~30% discount to HSBC, we expect STAN’s share price to react positively post-3Q and prefer STAN over HSBC and local HK banks in the coming six months.

- **What we like:** 1) NII of \$2.7bn was 2% above cons. and +1% q/q driven by volume growth partly offset by lower rates; pass-through rates in CIB continue to be better than MT expectations. AIEAs were +2% q/q with underlying loans +1% q/q driven by WRB +\$2bn q/q while CIB loans were flat, and underlying deposits were +2% q/q driven by WRB (+\$7bn) and CIB deposits (+\$4bn q/q) largely in CASA and Treasury. 2) Other income of \$2.4bn was 4% ahead of consensus. Total income was \$5.1bn and 3% ahead. This was supported by steady growth in flow base income (+3.5% q/q or +16% y/y) and robust growth in wealth solution fees (+20% q/q or +27% y/y), with new net money rising 15% YTD. 3) Costs of \$3.0bn were 1% below cons., driving PPOP of \$2.2bn, 10% ahead of cons. 4) Credit impairments of \$195m (24bps CoR) were below cons. of \$252m (and included a \$25mn overlay for HK CRE), driving underlying PBT of \$2.0bn 14% ahead of cons., while Reported PBT of \$1.8bn was 16% ahead of cons. 5) CET1 of 14.2% was 10bps ahead with RWAs in line. The minimum CET1 requirement now is 10.2% (prev. 10.5%) driven by a Pillar 2A reduction. 6) TNAV/share of 1,684c was in line with cons.
- **Outlook and guidance: 2025 income and RoTE guidance upgraded.** 1) 2025 income growth is now expected to be at the top end of the 5-7% range from a 2024 base of \$19.3bn (prev. near the bottom of a 5-7% range) vs cons. of 6.9% against this base. Within this, NII is still expected to be down LSD% y/y constant FX vs cons. -c2%. 2) 2025

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Overweight

2888.HK, 2888 HK

Price: HK\$153.00

28 Oct 2025

Price Target: HK\$168.00

PT End Date: 31 Dec 2026

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underlying RoTE is expected to be ~13% (compared to the prev. guidance of RoTE approaching 13% in 2026) vs cons. of 13.1%. ***And management expects RoTE to progress from the 2025 level going forward. Other guidance remains unchanged:*** 1) 2026 cost guidance was reiterated on a const. FX basis at below \$12.3bn which is \$12.4bn on current 2026 fwd FX rates (cons. \$12.4bn). 2) The Group continues to track towards the upper end of the 5-7% CAGR range for 2023-26E revenues, with a FY23 const. FX base of ~\$17.4bn, implying ~\$21.2bn FY26 assuming a 6.5% CAGR (vs cons. of \$21.1bn). Updated 2026 ROTE guidance will be provided in Feb '26 and the Group will share medium-term targets in May '26 when we expect the positive ROTE trajectory to continue.

- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX) in 3Q:** Global Markets +1% y/y (9% below cons.) with Macro -1% y/y and Credit +18% y/y; Global Markets driven by Flow income (+12% y/y) while episodic income was subdued (-36% y/y). Global Banking +24% y/y (10% above cons.) with Lending & Fin Solutions +22% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory +35% y/y. Wealth +28% y/y (16% above cons.) with \$13.3bn net new money (+28% y/y, \$42bn YTD at 15% growth of AUM, compared to ~\$200bn 5Y target from 2025) and ~67k new-to-bank affluent clients onboarded (~200k YTD and >60k average over the past six quarters).
- **Hong Kong business review.** STAN's HK revenue declined by 3% y/y in 3Q25, reversing from 18% y/y in 2Q25, while expense growth was resilient at 20% y/y, leading to negative jaws and bringing CIR up 9.7pcts y/y to 50.7%. As a result, PPOP contracted by 19% y/y in 3Q25, vs growth of 17% y/y in 2Q25. Loan impairment charges fell 15% y/y; therefore, credit cost on annualized basis edged down 7bps y/y to 31bps in 3Q. Loan growth of +6% q/q (+5% y/y) was ahead of Group loan trend (-1% q/q or -1% y/y), while deposit remained flat at 0% q/q (or +16% y/y).
- **HK CRE – a rise in Stage 2 and 3 loan ratios, but provision level improved:** In 3Q25, HK CRE exposure declined by 14% q/q to US\$1.8bn due to repayment, and accounted for 0.6% of the total loan book, edging down from 0.7% in 2Q25. 95% of the exposures are performing, while STAN conservatively increased the Stage 2 loan ratio by 11pcts q/q to 42%, as upcoming maturities are monitored. The Stage 3 loan ratio increased by 1pcts q/q to 5%, due to a decline in total balance, while there was no change to Stage 3 exposures. We note that 89% of exposure is secured (vs 81% in 2Q25) with an average LTV of <50%, and that office exposure was ~10% of book, fully secured. The provisions increased by 16% q/q to \$134mn in 3Q25 from \$116mn in 2Q25, and LLR/Loans improved to 7.4% in 3Q25 from 5.5% in 2Q25.
- **Likely changes to consensus:** The Group has upgraded FY25 total revenue guidance to the upper end of the 5-7% range (vs cons. ~7% on the 2024 base) with NII still expected to be down LSD%. Assuming a

2% decline in FY25 NII implies ~4% q/q NII decline for 4Q25 and 4Q25 non-NII +7% y/y, which we view as conservative. Assuming a 1% decline in FY25 NII implies flat q/q NII for 4Q25 and 4Q25 non-NII +1% y/y. Therefore, we expect LSD% EPS upgrades on slightly stronger revenues for 2025-27.

- **HK peer read-across - positive:** STAN HK loan growth +6% q/q, beat HSBC HK of -0.2% q/q; thus, we expect NII to be up or stable in 3Q. The 3% revenue contraction q/q is likely due to episodic Market revenue, with wealth continuing to be strong. STAN's HK CRE exposure is US\$1.8bn < 1.0% of Group loan book, while the Stage 3 loan ratio rose by 1ppts q/q to 5%, slowing down from +2ppt q/q in 2Q25. We also noted a rise in secured loans in 3Q vs 2Q, leading to a lower loss at default. The resilient opex is likely idiosyncratic to STAN as it is investing into people and tech infrastructure in HK, as well as reallocation of Group expenses.
- **Stock price reaction:** We expect stock to trade up post-3Q25 results.
- **Conference call details:** 08:00 UK/ 16:00 HK on Thursday, 30 October 2025. You will be able to access the presentation via a [webcast link](#) or by registering for the conference call using the [link](#) here.

Table 1: StanChart 3Q25 results summary

US\$ mn	3Q24	2Q25	3Q25E	3Q25 Cons	3Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,769	2,703	2,668	2,672	2,737	2%	3%	-1%	1%
Other Income	2,123	2,806	2,306	2,309	2,410	4%	5%	14%	-14%
Quarterly Revenue	4,892	5,509	4,973	4,981	5,147	3%	3%	5%	-7%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,572	1,469	1,431	1,461	1,488	2%	4%	-5%	1%
o.w. Global Banking	475	548	548	534	588	10%	7%	24%	7%
o.w. Global Markets	840	1,172	913	929	848	-9%	-7%	1%	-28%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	694	742	793	764	890	16%	12%	28%	20%
Operating expenses	-2,840	-3,050	-2,995	-2,980	-2,953	-1%	-1%	4%	-3%
Pre-provision operating profit	2,052	2,459	1,978	2,001	2,194	10%	11%	7%	-11%
Loan impairments	-178	-117	-210	-252	-195	-23%	-7%	10%	67%
Profits pre-other impairments/Assocs	1,874	2,342	1,768	1,749	1,999	14%	13%	7%	-15%
Other impairments	-92	-3	-9	-19	-20	5%			
Profit from associates	13	64	10	11	6	-45%	-40%	-54%	-91%
Clean Pretax profits	1,795	2,403	1,770	1,741	1,985	14%	12%	11%	-17%
Exceptional items	-73	-123	-250	-221	-219	-1%	-12%	200%	78%
Pretax profits	1,722	2,280	1,520	1,520	1,766	16%	16%	3%	-23%
CET1 ratio	14.2%	14.3%	14.0%	14.1%	14.2%	10 bps	21 bps	-3 bps	-15 bps
RWAs	248,924	259,684	261,726	259,400	258,378	0%	-1%	4%	-1%
Loans (amortized cost)	287,257	286,731	287,253	287,900	285,127	-1%	-1%	-1%	-1%
Customer deposits	478,140	517,390	513,937	516,000	526,284	2%	2%	10%	2%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, company data.

Table 2: StanChart 3Q25 product revenue

US\$ mn	3Q24	2Q25	3Q25E	3Q25 Cons	3Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,572	1,469	1,431	1,461	1,488	2%	4%	-5%	1%
Payments and Liquidity	1,112	1,013	983	1,000	1,016	2%	3%	-9%	0%
Securities Services	156	158	159	160	166	4%	4%	6%	5%
Trade & Working Capital	304	298	289	301	306	2%	6%	1%	3%
Banking	475	548	548	534	588	10%	7%	24%	7%
Lending & Financial Solutions	407	476	452	455	496	9%	10%	22%	4%
Capital Market & Advisory	68	72	96	79	92	16%	-4%	35%	28%
Markets	840	1,172	913	929	848	-9%	-7%	1%	-28%
Macro Trading	683	961	750	763	678	-11%	-10%	-1%	-29%
Credit Trading	174	187	168	176	206	17%	22%	18%	10%
Valuation & Other Adj	-17	24	-5	-7	-36	414%	620%	112%	-250%
Wealth Solutions	694	742	793	764	890	16%	12%	28%	20%
Investment Products	507	544	582	557	691	24%	19%	36%	27%
Bancassurance	187	198	211	203	199	-2%	-6%	6%	1%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	281	282	276	278	277	0%	0%	-1%	-2%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,051	990	960	984	1,034	5%	8%	-2%	4%
Ventures	43	278	59	59	39	-34%	-34%	-9%	-86%
Digital Banks	39	46	55	51	49	-4%	-	-	-
SCV	4	232	4	9	-10	-211%	-	-	-
Treasury & Other	-64	28	-7	-8	-17	113%	-	-	-
Total underlying operating income	4,892	5,509	4,973	5,001	5,147	3%	3%	5%	-7%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, company data.

Table 3: 3Q25 Hong Kong business results

Hong Kong (US\$ mn)	3Q24A	2Q25A	3Q25A	Q/Q	Y/Y
Operating income	1,257	1,414	1,220	-14%	-3%
Operating expenses	(515)	(599)	(618)	3%	20%
PPoP	742	815	602	-26%	-19%
Loan impairment	(81)	(79)	(69)	-13%	-15%
Other impairment	(40)	0	(1)	NA	-98%
Associates and JV	0	0	0	NA	NA
Underlying PBT	621	736	532	-28%	-14%
Total Assets	216,815	209,923	210,684	0%	-3%
Customer loans	87,200	86,140	91,282	6%	5%
Customer deposits	161,553	187,036	187,204	0%	16%
Average customer loans	85,736	86,170	88,711	3%	3%
Credit Costs	0.38%	0.37%	0.31%	-6 bps	-7 bps
Cost/ income ratio	41%	42%	51%	829 bps	969 bps
Loan to deposit ratio	54%	46%	49%	271 bps	-522 bps

Source: J.P. Morgan, company data.

Table 4: StanChart HK CRE exposure summary

In US\$ mn	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25
HK CRE exposure	2,600	2,300	2,600	2,200	2,100	1,800
Stage 1 ratio	NA	NA	79%	64%	65%	53%
Stage 2 ratio	NA	NA	21%	34%	31%	42%
Stage 3 ratio	0%	0%	0%	2%	4%	5%
HK CRE exposure as % of total	0.9%	0.8%	0.9%	0.8%	0.7%	0.6%
Provisions	0	34	58	82	116	134
NPL coverage ratio	NA	NA	NA	186%	138%	149%
LLR / Loans	0.0%	1.5%	2.2%	3.7%	5.5%	7.4%
Unsecured %	25%	14%	18%	17%	19%	11%
Secured %	75%	86%	82%	83%	81%	89%
Average LTV of secured loans	37%	<40%	<40%	~40%	<50%	<50%

Source: Company data.

Investment Thesis

We see StanChart as undervalued relative to its sector/EM peers at 1.0x PTNAV with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. We expect a ~7% revenue CAGR over '23-26E, driven by non-NII led by Wealth and Financial Markets, with the group's previous investments producing revenue momentum. NII is likely to be under pressure in '25E owing to lower rates, although this would be partly offset by volume growth, increased structural hedging and assertively managed deposits pass-through. We estimate a ~4% cost CAGR with the group's restructuring program likely to drive material cost saves by FY26, supporting a PPOP CAGR of 12% and RoTE improving to ~13% by FY26E. Capital remains strong; we forecast distributions of ~\$10.7bn compared to group targets of >\$8bn in '24-26E and expect a further \$1.5bn of share buybacks to be announced with FY25 results. CRE remains a risk, although we see the group as better positioned compared to peers and pro-actively managing higher-risk exposures lower. Maintain OW.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of HK\$168 is derived from our DDM analysis with NAV discounted back to Dec-26 from FY27E and a fair P/B of 0.92x. Our key assumptions are a normalized ROE of 8.3% and a cost of capital of 8.9%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

The key downside risks to our rating and price target include:

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. Potential weakness in China macro and regional sovereign continue to be risks towards revenues and impairments in the near term, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions to grow to above normalized levels by 2025 given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.
- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to the changes in the regulatory environment in the UK with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

Correction: Added important disclosures for HSBC.

Other Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 29 October 2025, unless otherwise indicated)

HSBC Holdings plc(HSBA.L/1073p/N)

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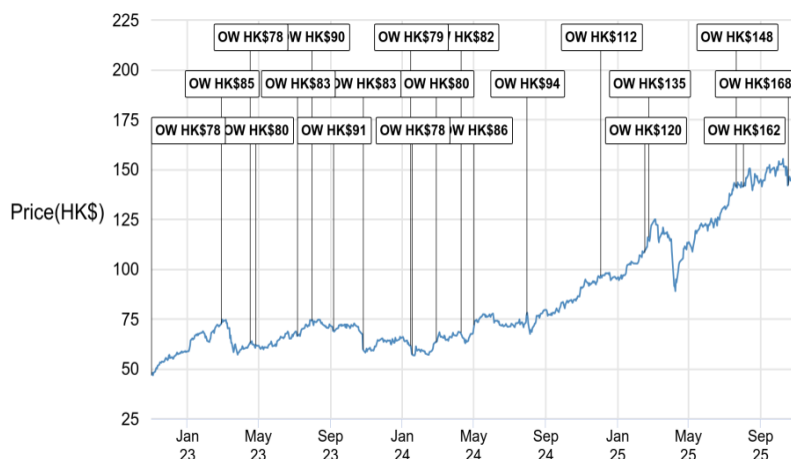
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Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888) (2888.HK, 2888 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
01-Nov-22	OW	46.95	78
28-Feb-23	OW	72.50	85
18-Apr-23	OW	63.05	78
28-Apr-23	OW	61.95	80
07-Jul-23	OW	66.55	83
01-Aug-23	OW	74.25	90
07-Sep-23	OW	69.20	91
27-Oct-23	OW	59.75	83
16-Jan-24	OW	61.55	79
18-Jan-24	OW	57.35	78
28-Feb-24	OW	63.35	80
10-Apr-24	OW	68.25	82
03-May-24	OW	71.95	86
31-Jul-24	OW	76.90	94
04-Dec-24	OW	96.80	112
17-Feb-25	OW	108.20	120
24-Feb-25	OW	116.00	135
22-Jul-25	OW	141.30	148
04-Aug-25	OW	141.30	162
19-Oct-25	OW	142.00	168

HSBC Holdings plc (HSBA.L, HSBA LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
06-Dec-22	N	500	570
27-Feb-23	N	636	650
17-Apr-23	N	584	630
07-Jul-23	N	610	680
16-Oct-23	N	653	690
16-Jan-24	N	596	660
22-Feb-24	N	590	600
10-Apr-24	N	645	660
01-May-24	N	696	700
15-Nov-24	N	706	730
06-Dec-24	N	751	780
20-Feb-25	N	895	900
20-Mar-25	N	896	920
01-May-25	N	832	830
01-Aug-25	N	923	870
09-Sep-25	N	970	940
17-Oct-25	N	989	950
29-Oct-25	N	1050	1,010

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